L3 LEA · S5 NORA VOUTEAU LLF5J30

Civilisation britannique : the UK since 1945

British civilisation: the United Kingdom since 1945 - explained workbook

6 · 16 EXERCISES

How to use this workbook

This workbook follows the six chapters of the course, from British institutions to the method of the document commentary. For each section, start by reading the reminder box: it sums up the facts and distinctions you must know. Then try each exercise on paper, following the guided method step by step before looking at anything else. Only then check the answer key: it explains why each answer is right and what reasoning you should have followed. Note the traps listed at the end of each exercise: they are the mistakes examiners see most often.

BASICS APPLICATION GOING FURTHER

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Exercices rédigés pour l'application à partir des fiches du cours ; les situations marquées « fictive » sont inventées. En cas de différence avec le cours de l'enseignant, c'est le cours qui fait foi.

PART 1

British institutions: who does what?

Key points

- The United Kingdom is a constitutional monarchy and a parliamentary system. Its constitution is uncodified (not written in a single text): it rests on Acts of Parliament (statutes), court decisions, constitutional conventions and historical documents.
- The Westminster Parliament comprises the monarch, the House of Commons (650 elected MPs) and the House of Lords (unelected: life peers, a limited number of hereditary peers, bishops of the Church of England). The power of delay of the Lords is limited by the Parliament Acts of 1911 and 1949.
- Parliamentary sovereignty: Parliament can pass or repeal any law.
- The Prime Minister is the leader of the party that holds a majority in the Commons; the government and the Cabinet are collectively responsible to the Commons. The monarch reigns but does not rule. The second-largest party forms the Official Opposition, with a shadow cabinet.
- General elections use first past the post: in each of the 650 constituencies, the candidate who comes first is elected, even without an absolute majority. The system favours the two main parties (Conservatives and Labour), penalises parties whose votes are spread thinly and helps regionally concentrated parties such as the SNP.

EXERCISE 1.1 BASICS

Classifying the roles of British institutions

Objective : *Understand the division of roles between the Crown, the two Houses, the Prime Minister and Cabinet, and the Opposition, and why power rests on the majority in the Commons.*

Below are ten statements describing a function or a feature of a British institution. Each one belongs to one of the following: (A) the Monarch, (B) the House of Commons, (C) the House of Lords, (D) the Prime Minister and Cabinet, (E) the Official Opposition, (F) Parliament as a whole.

NO.	STATEMENT
1	Gives Royal Assent to bills.
2	Is made up of 650 Members elected by universal suffrage.
3	Is not elected; its members are mostly appointed life peers.
4	Is collectively responsible to the elected chamber.
5	Forms a shadow cabinet that mirrors the ministers.
6	Can pass or repeal any law (principle of sovereignty).
7	Passes the budget and scrutinises the government.
8	Examines and amends bills but can only delay them.
9	Is led by the leader of the party with a majority in the Commons.
10	Reigns but does not rule; delivers the King's (or Queen's) Speech.

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. Start with the easiest clue in each statement: is the institution elected or not? Only the House of Commons is elected by universal suffrage.
> 2. Ask yourself whether the statement describes a symbolic act (typical of the Monarch), a legislative act (Commons, Lords, Parliament), or an act of government (Prime Minister and Cabinet).
> 3. Remember the key mechanism: the government comes from the majority in the Commons and must keep its confidence. Anything about 'responsibility' or 'majority leader' points to the executive.
> 4. Do not confuse the House of Commons with Parliament as a whole: Parliament is the monarch plus the two Houses, and it is Parliament that is sovereign.
> 5. Then answer the two short questions in full sentences, using the vocabulary of the reminder.

Questions

1. Match each statement (1 to 10) with the right institution (A to F).

2. True or false? 'The United Kingdom has no constitution.' Justify your answer.

3. Explain in two or three sentences why a British Prime Minister can change in the middle of a Parliament without a general election.

EXERCISE 1.2 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

First past the post in action: votes versus seats

Objective : *Calculate a fictional election result to see how first past the post amplifies some parties and penalises others.*

In an imaginary region with five constituencies of 10,000 voters each, three parties stand: Party X (votes evenly spread), Party Y (very strong in one constituency) and Party Z (a third party whose votes are spread thinly). The results are given below. The rules are those of a British general election.

CONSTITUENCY	PARTY X	PARTY Y	PARTY Z	TOTAL
A	4,000	3,500	2,500	10,000
B	4,000	3,600	2,400	10,000
C	4,000	3,400	2,600	10,000
D	2,500	5,500	2,000	10,000
E	3,500	3,300	3,200	10,000

Step-by-step method

1. Under first past the post, look at each constituency separately: the candidate with the most votes wins the seat, even with less than 50%.
2. Add up each party's votes over the five constituencies, then divide by the total (50,000) to get its share of the vote in %.
3. Count each party's seats and divide by 5 to get its share of the seats in %.
4. Compare the two percentages for each party: is the party over-represented or under-represented?
5. Finally, connect your numbers to the course: two-party system, thinly spread third parties, regionally concentrated parties.

Questions

1. Who wins each constituency? In which constituency is the winner elected without an absolute majority?
2. Calculate each party's total votes and share of the vote.
3. Calculate each party's number of seats and share of the seats.
4. Comment on the result: which party is the big winner, which is the big loser, and why?
5. Using the course, explain why this system tends to produce a two-party system in Britain, and why the SNP is an exception.

PART 2

Building the Welfare State (1942-1951)

Key points

- The Beveridge Report, 'Social Insurance and Allied Services' (December 1942), by the Liberal economist William Beveridge, proposed universal social security 'from the cradle to the grave' against five giants: Want, Disease, Ignorance, Squalor and Idleness (unemployment).
- Beveridge's scheme: a single national social insurance financed by flat-rate contributions, giving flat-rate benefits; it assumed a national health service, family allowances and full employment.
- July 1945: Clement Attlee's Labour Party defeats Churchill's Conservatives. The Attlee government (1945-1951) passes the National Insurance Act (1946), the National Health Service Act (1946) and the National Assistance Act (1948). The Education Act 1944 (Butler) had already made secondary education free.
- The NHS is launched on 5 July 1948 under Aneurin Bevan: care free at the point of use, financed by taxation (a 'Beveridgean' model, unlike the contributory 'Bismarckian' French Sécurité sociale).
- Nationalisations, in line with Clause IV: Bank of England and civil aviation (1946), coal (1947, National Coal Board), railways and transport, electricity (1948), gas (1949), iron and steel (1951, denationalised in 1953, renationalised in 1967). Around a fifth of the economy came under public control: a mixed economy.

EXERCISE 2.1 BASICS

The five giants and the responses to them

Objective : *Know the five giants of the Beveridge Report, understand what each word means and link each giant to the policy designed to defeat it.*

Beveridge used deliberately striking, old-fashioned words to describe the five social evils of Britain. Column 1 lists the giants, column 2 gives their meaning in modern English in the wrong order, and column 3 lists the responses in the wrong order.

GIANT	MEANING (JUMBLED)	RESPONSE (JUMBLED)
Want	a) poor housing, slums	i) full employment (Keynesian policy)
Disease	b) lack of education	ii) housing and town planning
Ignorance	c) unemployment	iii) national social insurance, minimum benefits
Squalor	d) poverty, lack of income	iv) free national health service
Idleness	e) illness, poor health	v) education (Education Act 1944)

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. Translate each giant into a plain idea first: 'want' means lacking what you need; 'squalor' means dirty, miserable living conditions; 'idleness' means having no work.
> 2. Then ask: which public policy removes that problem? Lack of income is answered by benefits; illness by health care; and so on.
> 3. Be careful with 'idleness': in Beveridge's sense it does not mean laziness but unemployment, so the answer is a policy, not a moral judgment.
> 4. For question 3, think about who wrote the report and who applied it: the two are not the same person nor the same party.

Questions

1. Match each giant with its meaning (a to e).

2. Match each giant with the response (i to v).

3. 'The Beveridge Report was a Labour programme.' Correct this statement.

4. Explain the phrase 'from the cradle to the grave' and the notion of universalism.

EXERCISE 2.2 APPLICATION

Completing the timeline of the Attlee years

Objective : *Put the founding measures of the Welfare State and the nationalisations in chronological order and understand what each of them changed.*

The timeline below has gaps. Complete it using the reminder and your course, then answer the questions.

DATE	EVENT OR MEASURE
December 1942	..... (author: .....)
1944	Education Act (Butler): .....
July 1945	.....
1946	National Insurance Act; .....; nationalisation of the ..... and of civil aviation
1947	Nationalisation of ..... (National Coal Board)
5 July 1948	..... (Minister: .....)
1948	National Assistance Act; nationalisation of ..... and .....
1949	Nationalisation of .....
1951	Nationalisation of .....

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. Fill in the dates you are sure of first (1942, 1945, 1948), then place the others around them.
> 2. Distinguish two kinds of measures: social measures (insurance, health, assistance, education) and economic measures (nationalisations). You may use two colours.
> 3. Remember that a law and its implementation are two steps: the NHS Act dates from 1946, the NHS itself from 5 July 1948.
> 4. For question 3, follow the history of iron and steel after 1951 and ask yourself which party was in power at each date.

Questions

1. Complete the timeline.

2. Classify the measures into 'social' and 'economic' measures.

3. Why is iron and steel a good example of the alternation of power in British politics?

4. What were the aims of nationalisation, and what is a 'mixed economy'?

EXERCISE 2.3 GOING FURTHER

From a wartime report to the NHS: a cause and consequence chain

Objective : *Link the events of 1942-1948 by cause and consequence and explain the specificity of the British model of the Welfare State.*

An examiner asks: 'Explain how the Second World War led to the creation of the British Welfare State.' You must answer with a reasoned chain, then a short paragraph.

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. A cause and consequence chain is a series of links: each step must explain the next one. Use connectors: 'because', 'therefore', 'as a result', 'which led to'.
> 2. Start from the context: a country at war, with a coalition government, that needs a programme for reconstruction.
> 3. Then place the report (1942), its popularity, the July 1945 election, and the laws that followed.
> 4. To compare with France, use the distinction from the course: tax-funded ('Beveridgean') versus contribution-based ('Bismarckian').
> 5. Write the paragraph with one idea per sentence, and include at least three precise dates or laws.

Questions

1. Put these elements in a logical chain and explain each link: July 1945 election; Beveridge Report; launch of the NHS; National Health Service Act; popularity of the report among voters; wartime need for a reconstruction programme.

2. Explain how the NHS is financed and how this differs from the French Sécurité sociale.

3. Write a paragraph of about eight lines answering the examiner's question.

PART 3

Consensus, decline and the crisis of the 1970s

Key points

- Post-war consensus: back in power in 1951, the Conservatives (Churchill, Eden, Macmillan) kept most of the Labour legacy: Welfare State and NHS, mixed economy, full employment through Keynesian demand management, consultation with the trade unions. 'Butskellism' (The Economist, 1954) merges Rab Butler and Hugh Gaitskell. Historians debate its extent.
- Relative decline: Britain grows, but more slowly than West Germany, France or Japan. 'Stop-go': expansion leads to inflation and an external deficit, then pressure on sterling forces restraint. Devaluations in 1949 and 1967.
- Europe: ECSC (1951) and EEC (1957) turned down; EFTA founded in 1960; applications in 1961 and 1967 vetoed by de Gaulle (1963, 1967); accession on 1 January 1973 (Heath); referendum of June 1975: about 67% in favour of staying in.
- The 1970s: miners' strikes (1972, 1974), oil shock (1973), three-day week, Heath's defeat in February 1974 ('Who governs Britain?'); stagflation (inflation above 20% in 1975), IMF loan (1976); Winter of Discontent (1978-1979); Callaghan loses a vote of no confidence in March 1979; Thatcher wins in May 1979.

EXERCISE 3.1 BASICS

What did the consensus consist of?

Objective : *Identify the pillars of the post-war consensus and understand the term 'Butskellism'.*

Read the following eight statements about Britain between 1951 and the 1970s and decide whether each is true or false.

NO.	STATEMENT
1	When they returned to power in 1951, the Conservatives abolished the NHS.
2	Most nationalisations were kept by the Conservatives, except steel and road haulage.
3	Both main parties aimed at full employment through Keynesian demand management.
4	The trade unions were excluded from economic negotiations.
5	'Butskellism' was coined by The Economist in 1954.
6	Butler was a Labour Chancellor and Gaitskell a Conservative one.
7	Historians all agree on the extent of the consensus.
8	Thatcherism defined itself against this consensus.

Step-by-step method

1. List the five pillars of the consensus from the reminder: Welfare State and NHS, mixed economy, Keynesian full employment, consultation with the unions (corporatism), gradual decolonisation and special relationship with the United States.
2. For each statement, check whether it agrees with one pillar or contradicts it.
3. For statements 5 and 6, break the word 'Butskellism' into its two names and recall each man's party.
4. Correct every false statement in a full sentence: a corrected statement is worth more than a simple 'false'.

Questions

1. True or false? Correct the false statements.

2. Explain in your own words why we speak of a 'consensus' even though the two parties remained rivals.

EXERCISE 3.2 APPLICATION

Stop-go and the European question: putting things in order

Objective : *Reconstruct the logic of the stop-go cycle and the stages of Britain's late entry into Europe.*

Part A: the five stages of the stop-go cycle are jumbled: (a) pressure on sterling; (b) slowdown and unemployment, then a new expansion; (c) demand is boosted by tax cuts and credit; (d) restraint: higher interest rates and credit restrictions; (e) rising imports, inflation and an external deficit. Part B: match the dates 1957, 1960, 1963, 1973, 1975 with the following events: EFTA founded; accession to the European Community under Heath; EEC turned down; referendum on staying in; first veto by de Gaulle.

Step-by-step method

1. For Part A, start from the 'go' phase (an expansion decided by the government), then ask at each step: what is the consequence of this?
2. Remember the chain: more demand means more imports and higher prices; an external deficit weakens the currency; the government must then cool the economy.
3. For Part B, remember that Britain first refused to join, then created a rival organisation, then applied and was blocked, and finally joined.
4. For question 4, think about the reasons given in the course: the Commonwealth, the special relationship and sovereignty.

Questions

1. Put the stages of the stop-go cycle in the right order and explain each link.

2. Why does stop-go illustrate the idea of 'relative decline'?

3. Match the dates and the events of Part B.

4. Why did Britain join the European Community so late?

EXERCISE 3.3 GOING FURTHER

How the crisis of the 1970s paved the way for Thatcher

Objective : *Build an argued explanation of the end of the consensus, using dates and actors.*

Exam question: 'How did the crisis of the 1970s pave the way for Margaret Thatcher's victory in 1979?' Prepare the answer in the form of a chronological chain followed by a structured plan.

Step-by-step method

1. Start by listing the events of the decade with their dates and the Prime Minister in office (Heath 1970-1974, then Wilson, then Callaghan).
2. Sort the events into three families: industrial conflict (strikes), economic crisis (oil shock, stagflation, IMF), political consequences (elections, no confidence).
3. Ask yourself what each government failed to do: control the unions? control inflation? This failure is what made a break with the consensus look necessary.
4. Build a plan in two or three parts, each with a clear idea and dated examples.

Questions

1. Put these events in order with their date: IMF loan; Winter of Discontent; oil shock and three-day week; vote of no confidence against Callaghan; miners' strikes; Heath's defeat after asking 'Who governs Britain?'.

2. Define stagflation and explain why it challenged Keynesian policy.

3. Propose a two- or three-part plan answering the exam question.

PART 4

Thatcherism (1979-1990)

Key points

- Monetarism (inspired by Friedman and Hayek): priority to fighting inflation by controlling the money supply (Medium-Term Financial Strategy, 1980), cutting the deficit and keeping interest rates high, at the expense of full employment. The 1980–1981 recession pushed unemployment above three million. 'There is no alternative' (TINA).
- Privatisation (change of owner): British Telecom (1984), British Gas (1986, 'Tell Sid'), British Airways and Rolls-Royce (1987), British Steel (1988), water (1989), electricity (1990–1991). Right to Buy (Housing Act 1980). Aims: efficiency, revenue, weaker unions, 'popular capitalism'.
- Trade unions: Employment Acts 1980 and 1982 (picketing, secondary action, closed shop), Trade Union Act 1984 (secret ballot before a strike); miners' strike (March 1984 - March 1985, NUM, Arthur Scargill), ended in defeat.
- Big Bang (27 October 1986, deregulation = change of rules): end of fixed commissions and of the broker / jobber separation, foreign banks admitted, electronic trading; prepared by the abolition of exchange controls (1979).
- Downfall: the poll tax (Community Charge), a flat-rate charge per adult (Scotland 1989, England and Wales April 1990), riots on 31 March 1990; divisions over Europe, Geoffrey Howe's resignation, Heseltine's challenge; Thatcher withdraws in November 1990, replaced by John Major. She was removed by her own party, not by voters.

EXERCISE 4.1 BASICS

Keynesianism or monetarism? Privatisation or deregulation?

Objective : *Distinguish the economic logic of the consensus from that of Thatcherism, and the two strands of Thatcherite liberalisation.*

Part A: classify each statement as 'Keynesianism' (K) or 'monetarism' (M). Part B: classify each measure as 'privatisation' (P), 'deregulation' (D) or 'trade union law' (U).

PART	ITEM
A1	The priority is full employment.
A2	The priority is price stability.
A3	The state supports demand when unemployment rises.
A4	The growth of the money supply must be controlled.
A5	Public spending and the budget deficit must be cut.
B1	Sale of British Telecom (1984)
B2	Big Bang in the City (1986)
B3	Compulsory secret ballot before a strike (1984)
B4	Abolition of exchange controls (1979)
B5	Sale of the water companies (1989)
B6	Limits on picketing and secondary action (1980, 1982)

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. For Part A, ask: what is the main enemy? If it is unemployment, it is Keynesian; if it is inflation, it is monetarist.
> 2. For Part B, use the test from the course: does the measure change the owner of a company (privatisation) or the rules of a market (deregulation)? If it concerns strikes or unions, it is a union law.
> 3. Then explain the slogan TINA: what alternative did Thatcher refuse?

Questions

1. Classify items A1 to A5.

2. Classify items B1 to B6.

3. Explain the meaning of 'There is no alternative' and of 'The lady's not for turning' in the context of 1980.

EXERCISE 4.2 APPLICATION

A Thatcherite timeline and the aims of privatisation

Objective : *Order the main measures and events of the Thatcher years and explain the political aims of privatisation.*

You are preparing revision cards. Place the following items on a timeline from 1979 to 1990: Right to Buy; British Telecom privatised; Big Bang; miners' strike; poll tax introduced in England and Wales; Thatcher's resignation; abolition of exchange controls; British Gas privatised ('Tell Sid'); Trafalgar Square riot; British Airways and Rolls-Royce privatised.

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. Start with the beginning and the end (1979 and November 1990), then fill in the middle year by year.
> 2. Several things happen in the same year (1984, 1986, 1990): write them on the same line and check the month when the course gives it.
> 3. For question 2, remember the four aims given in the course, and do not forget the political dimension: who owns shares, who owns homes?
> 4. For question 3, give both sides: achievements and criticisms.

Questions

1. Draw the timeline with the date of each item.

2. What were the aims of privatisation? Explain the expressions 'popular capitalism' and 'property-owning democracy'.

3. Give two arguments in favour of privatisation and two criticisms, as presented in the course.

EXERCISE 4.3 GOING FURTHER

Why did Margaret Thatcher leave office in 1990? An essay plan

Objective : *Organise several causes into a hierarchy and write the plan of a short essay.*

Essay question: 'Why did Margaret Thatcher leave office in November 1990?' A student writes in the introduction: 'Thatcher lost the 1990 election because of the poll tax.' Correct this sentence, then build an essay plan.

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. First check the facts: was there a general election in 1990? How was Thatcher replaced?
> 2. List the causes in the course: the poll tax (what it was, why it was seen as unfair, how people reacted), divisions over Europe, Geoffrey Howe's resignation, Heseltine's challenge.
> 3. Distinguish deep causes (unpopular policy, internal divisions) from the trigger (the leadership challenge).
> 4. Build a plan that goes from the deep causes to the trigger, and end with the consequence (Major, council tax).

Questions

1. Correct the student's sentence and explain your correction.
2. Explain why the poll tax was seen as unfair.
3. Propose a three-part plan with examples.

PART 5

From Major to New Labour (1990-2007)

Key points

- John Major (1990–1997): council tax replaces the poll tax; 1992 election won narrowly; Black Wednesday (16 September 1992): sterling leaves the European Exchange Rate Mechanism; Maastricht ratified in 1993 with opt-outs (single currency, Social Chapter); sleaze; Downing Street Declaration (1993); rail privatisation. Labour landslide on 1 May 1997.
- New Labour and the Third Way (Anthony Giddens): Clause IV rewritten in 1995; acceptance of the market and of the Thatcherite legacy (no renationalisation), investment in education, health and welfare to work. Bank of England independence (1997), national minimum wage (1998), Human Rights Act (1998), devolution; Iraq War (2003); Gordon Brown in 2007.
- Devolution: transfer of powers to elected institutions without federalism (Westminster remains sovereign). Referendums of September 1997; Scotland Act 1998 (Scottish Parliament, Holyrood); Government of Wales Act 1998 (Assembly, now the Senedd); Northern Ireland Act 1998. West Lothian question. 2014 Scottish referendum: 55% No.
- Good Friday (Belfast) Agreement, signed on 10 April 1998, approved by twin referendums on 22 May 1998: principle of consent, power-sharing, North-South and East-West bodies, decommissioning, release of prisoners. It ended the Troubles (more than 3,500 dead) between republicans/nationalists and unionists/loyalists.

EXERCISE 5.1 BASICS

Old Labour or New Labour? Devolution or federalism?

Objective : *Understand what New Labour changed in Labour's doctrine and what devolution does and does not mean.*

Part A: classify the following as 'Old Labour' or 'New Labour': common ownership of the means of production (Clause IV before 1995); acceptance of the market economy; nationalisations of 1946-1951; welfare to work; close links with the trade unions; no renationalisation of privatised companies; investment in education and health within a market economy. Part B: answer the questions on devolution.

Step-by-step method

1. For Part A, ask: does the idea come before or after Tony Blair's modernisation of the party (from 1994)?
2. The Third Way tries to combine market economics and social justice: a New Labour item usually accepts the market and adds a social objective.
3. For Part B, compare the two systems: in federalism, sovereignty is shared and guaranteed; in devolution, Westminster gives powers and remains sovereign.
4. The West Lothian question is easier to explain with a concrete example: an MP from Scotland voting on a law that only applies in England.

Questions

1. Classify the seven items of Part A.
2. What is the difference between devolution and federalism? Is the United Kingdom a federal state?
3. Explain the West Lothian question with an example.
4. Which nation of the United Kingdom has no parliament of its own?

EXERCISE 5.2 APPLICATION

The years 1992-1998: a timeline and the Good Friday Agreement

Objective : *Order the key events from Black Wednesday to the Good Friday Agreement and explain the main principles of the Agreement.*

Complete the table, then answer the questions on the Good Friday Agreement.

DATE	EVENT	PRIME MINISTER
16 September 1992	.....	.....
1993	Ratification of ..... with opt-outs; Downing Street Declaration	.....
1995	.....	(Labour leader: .....)
1 May 1997	.....	.....
1997	Independence of the ..... over monetary policy	.....
10 April 1998	.....	.....
22 May 1998	.....	.....
1999	First elections to the	.....

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. Use the turning point of 1 May 1997 to fill in the last column: before it, John Major; from it, Tony Blair.
> 2. For the Agreement, distinguish signature (by governments and parties) from approval (by the people, in two referendums).
> 3. To explain the principle of consent, ask: who decides whether Northern Ireland stays British?
> 4. For the last question, think about what a border between the United Kingdom and an EU member state means after Brexit.

Questions

1. Complete the table.

2. Explain why Black Wednesday weakened the Conservatives.

3. Explain three principles of the Good Friday Agreement.

4. Why did the Irish border become an issue in the Brexit negotiations?

PART 6

Method: the document commentary and the essay

Key points

- A commentary presents, explains and interprets a document by placing it in its historical context; it is not a paraphrase or a summary.
- Introduction: nature, author, date, source, intended audience, context; central question; announced outline.
- Development: thematic (not line-by-line), two or three parts, precise knowledge (dates, laws, actors), short quotations with line references.
- Critical perspective: the author's point of view, intentions, what he or she leaves out. Conclusion: answer the central question and open onto later developments.
- Useful expressions: 'This document is an extract from a speech delivered by… on…'; 'At the time, Britain was facing…'; 'As the author puts it, "…" (l. 12)'; 'However, the author fails to mention…'; 'This document thus sheds light on…'.

EXERCISE 6.1 BASICS FICTIONAL SITUATION

Presenting a document and avoiding paraphrase

Objective : *Identify the elements of a document's presentation and tell the difference between commentary and paraphrase.*

Document (fictional): an editorial published on 15 November 1984 in an imaginary national daily, The Northern Courier, signed by its editor, James Holt. Addressed to its readers in the industrial North, it argues that the miners 'are fighting for their communities, not against the nation' and criticises the government for 'closing pits that whole towns depend on'. Below are four sentences written by students about this document.

SENTENCE	TEXT
S1	The author says that the miners are fighting for their communities and that the government closes pits.
S2	Published eight months into the miners' strike led by Arthur Scargill's NUM, this editorial takes sides against the closure of pits deemed uneconomic by the National Coal Board.
S3	Then the author says that whole towns depend on the pits.
S4	However, the editor fails to mention that the strike was called without a national ballot, a point the government used against the NUM.

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. To present a document, answer six questions: what is it (nature)? who wrote it? when? where was it published (source)? for whom (audience)? in what context?
> 2. To spot paraphrase, ask: does the sentence only repeat the text in other words, or does it add knowledge, context or a critical view?
> 3. A good commentary sentence contains at least one element that is NOT in the document (a date, an actor, a law, a consequence).
> 4. Then use the expressions of the reminder to write the presentation.

Questions

1. Identify the nature, author, date, source, audience and context of the document.
2. Classify sentences S1 to S4 as 'paraphrase' or 'commentary' and justify.
3. Write a two-sentence presentation of the document using the expressions of the course.

EXERCISE 6.2 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Building a commentary plan for a 1997 campaign speech

Objective : *Go from a document to a central question and a thematic plan, using course knowledge.*

Document (fictional): an extract from a speech delivered in April 1997 by an imaginary Labour candidate, Sarah Lennox, at a meeting in Glasgow during the general election campaign. She declares: 'We will not go back to the old ways of nationalisation. But we will give every worker a fair minimum wage, and we will give Scotland its own Parliament.' She attacks 'eighteen years of Conservative government' and the 'humiliation of Black Wednesday'.

Step-by-step method

1. Read the document and underline every reference that needs explaining with outside knowledge: 'old ways of nationalisation', 'minimum wage', 'Scotland its own Parliament', 'eighteen years', 'Black Wednesday'.
2. For each reference, write what the course says (date, law, actor).
3. Group the references by theme, not in the order of the text: here, a break with Old Labour, a social programme, a constitutional programme, an attack on the Conservatives.
4. Formulate a central question that covers the whole document, using 'how' or 'to what extent'.
5. Build two or three parts with a title and two pieces of evidence each; plan a conclusion that opens onto what happened after 1 May 1997.

Questions

1. Explain the five underlined references with your course knowledge.

2. Formulate a central question.

3. Propose a thematic plan in three parts.

4. Write the conclusion, with an opening.

EXERCISE 6.3 GOING FURTHER

Essay plan: Thatcherism and the post-war consensus

Objective : *Use the whole course to build a nuanced essay plan on continuity and break.*

Essay question: 'To what extent did Thatcherism break with the post-war consensus?'

> **Step-by-step method**
>
> 1. 'To what extent' calls for a nuanced answer: show the break, then its limits, rather than saying yes or no.
> 2. Take the pillars of the consensus one by one (Welfare State and NHS, mixed economy, Keynesian full employment, role of the unions) and ask what Thatcher did with each.
> 3. Look for continuities too: did the NHS disappear? What did New Labour keep afterwards?
> 4. Each part needs dated evidence from the course. Avoid evidence that is not in your course.

Questions

1. For each pillar of the consensus, say whether Thatcherism broke with it, and give evidence.

2. Write a short introduction (definition of the terms, central question, outline).

3. Propose a plan in two or three parts with evidence.

Explained answer key

Exercise 1.1 · Classifying the roles of British institutions

1. 1. 1-A (Royal Assent is a formal, symbolic act of the Monarch); 2-B (the Commons is the only elected chamber, 650 MPs); 3-C (the Lords are unelected: life peers, some hereditary peers, bishops); 4-D (collective Cabinet responsibility to the Commons); 5-E (the shadow cabinet is the Opposition's team); 6-F (sovereignty belongs to Parliament as a whole, not to one House); 7-B (the Commons passes laws and the budget and scrutinises the government); 8-C (the Parliament Acts of 1911 and 1949 reduced the Lords to a power of delay); 9-D (the Prime Minister is the leader of the majority party); 10-A (the Monarch reigns but does not rule).
2. 2. False. The United Kingdom does have a constitution, but it is uncodified: it is not written in one single document but spread across statutes, court decisions, constitutional conventions and historical documents. Confusing 'uncodified' with 'non-existent' is a classic error.
3. 3. The Prime Minister's power does not come from a direct popular vote but from the majority in the House of Commons: he or she is the leader of the party that holds that majority. If the majority party changes its leader, the new leader becomes Prime Minister while the same MPs, elected at the last general election, keep supporting the government. No new election is therefore needed.
4. Final result: the logic of the system is that legitimacy flows from the elected Commons to the government; the Monarch is symbolic and the Lords can only revise and delay.

Traps to avoid : Saying that the House of Lords is elected: it is not. · Saying that the Monarch governs: the Monarch is Head of State with a ceremonial role. · Attributing sovereignty to the House of Commons alone instead of to Parliament. · Thinking that the British elect their Prime Minister directly.

Exercise 1.2 · First past the post in action: votes versus seats

1. 1. A: X (4,000); B: X (4,000); C: X (4,000); D: Y (5,500); E: X (3,500). In E, X wins with only 35% of the votes (3,500 out of 10,000): there is no absolute majority, but under first past the post coming first is enough. In A, B and C, X also wins with 40%, again without an absolute majority.
2. 2. X: 4,000 x 3 + 2,500 + 3,500 = 18,000 votes, i.e. 18,000 / 50,000 = 36%. Y: 3,500 + 3,600 + 3,400 + 5,500 + 3,300 = 19,300 votes, i.e. 38.6%. Z: 2,500 + 2,400 + 2,600 + 2,000 + 3,200 = 12,700 votes, i.e. 25.4%. Check: 18,000 + 19,300 + 12,700 = 50,000.
3. 3. X: 4 seats out of 5 = 80%. Y: 1 seat = 20%. Z: 0 seats = 0%.
4. 4. X is the big winner: with 36% of the votes it gets 80% of the seats, because its votes are spread efficiently, just enough to come first almost everywhere. Y actually wins the most votes (38.6%) but only one seat: many of its votes are 'wasted' in D, where it piles up a huge lead, and it comes second elsewhere. Z is the big loser: a quarter of the votes and no seat at all, because it comes third everywhere. This is the amplifying effect of the plurality system: it often produces a clear majority on a minority of the vote.
5. 5. Because only first place counts, voters and resources concentrate on the two parties that can win locally, the Conservatives and Labour; parties whose votes are spread thinly (Liberal Democrats, Reform UK, Greens) win few seats, like Z. A party whose votes are concentrated in one area, like the SNP in Scotland, can come first in many constituencies there and win many seats, a little like Y in constituency D. The course adds that a 2011 referendum rejected a switch to the Alternative Vote.
6. Final result: X 36% of votes / 80% of seats; Y 38.6% / 20%; Z 25.4% / 0%.

Traps to avoid : Believing an MP needs an absolute majority (over 50%) to be elected. · Assuming that the party with the most votes overall necessarily wins the most seats. · Forgetting to check that the vote totals add up to 50,000.

Exercise 2.1 · The five giants and the responses to them

1. 1. Want-d (poverty); Disease-e (illness); Ignorance-b (lack of education); Squalor-a (slums, poor housing); Idleness-c (unemployment).
2. 2. Want-iii (national social insurance guarantees a minimum income); Disease-iv (a free national health service); Ignorance-v (the Education Act 1944 made secondary education free); Squalor-ii (housing and town planning); Idleness-i (a policy of full employment, inspired by Keynes).
3. 3. The report was written by William Beveridge, a Liberal economist, in 1942, under the wartime coalition government. It was the Labour government of Clement Attlee, elected in July 1945, that implemented it. Report = Liberal author under a coalition; implementation = Labour.
4. 4. 'From the cradle to the grave' means that social protection covers every stage of life, from birth to death (illness, unemployment, old age, family). Universalism means that benefits are for everyone, without means-testing: all citizens pay flat-rate contributions and receive flat-rate benefits.
5. Final result: five giants, five public responses, which together form the programme of the Welfare State.

Traps to avoid : Translating 'idleness' as laziness: here it means unemployment. · Attributing the report to Attlee or to the Labour Party. · Forgetting that the Education Act 1944 (Butler) was passed before the 1945 Labour victory.

Exercise 2.2 · Completing the timeline of the Attlee years

1. 1. December 1942: Beveridge Report, 'Social Insurance and Allied Services' (William Beveridge). 1944: Education Act, free secondary education. July 1945: Labour victory, Clement Attlee becomes Prime Minister. 1946: National Insurance Act; National Health Service Act; nationalisation of the Bank of England and of civil aviation. 1947: coal. 5 July 1948: launch of the NHS (Aneurin Bevan). 1948: National Assistance Act; railways and transport, electricity. 1949: gas. 1951: iron and steel.
2. 2. Social: Beveridge Report, Education Act 1944, National Insurance Act, NHS Act and launch of the NHS, National Assistance Act. Economic: the nationalisations of 1946 to 1951.
3. 3. Iron and steel was nationalised by Labour in 1951, denationalised by the Conservatives in 1953, then renationalised by Labour in 1967. Each change of majority at Westminster brought a change of ownership: since Parliament is sovereign, a new majority can repeal what the previous one did. It also shows that the consensus had limits: most nationalisations were kept, but steel remained a point of disagreement.
4. 4. In line with Clause IV of the Labour constitution (common ownership of the means of production), the aims were to modernise ageing industries, guarantee employment and plan reconstruction in strategic or failing sectors. A mixed economy is one where a public sector (here about a fifth of the economy) coexists with a private sector.
5. Final result: between 1942 and 1951, Britain moved from a report to a complete system of social protection and a mixed economy.

Traps to avoid : Dating the NHS to 1946: 1946 is the Act, 1948 the launch. · Thinking that all nationalisations happened in 1945. · Forgetting the denationalisation of steel in 1953.

Exercise 2.3 · From a wartime report to the NHS: a cause and consequence chain

1. 1. Wartime need for a programme -> Beveridge Report (December 1942), which proposes to fight the five giants -> the report is hugely popular and gives reconstruction a programme -> in July 1945, voters give Labour a landslide victory over Churchill's Conservatives -> the Attlee government passes the National Health Service Act (1946) -> the NHS is launched on 5 July 1948. Each link is a consequence of the previous one: the report creates expectations, the election expresses them, the laws satisfy them.
2. 2. The NHS is financed by taxation and is free at the point of use: the patient pays nothing directly. The French Sécurité sociale is based mainly on contributions linked to work. The British system is called 'Beveridgean' (tax-funded, universal) and the French one 'Bismarckian' (contributory).
3. 3. Model paragraph: The Second World War gave Britain the opportunity to rethink its social model. In December 1942, the Liberal economist William Beveridge published 'Social Insurance and Allied Services', which proposed to defeat five giants, Want, Disease, Ignorance, Squalor and Idleness, through universal social insurance 'from the cradle to the grave'. The report was hugely popular and became a programme for peace. In July 1945, voters chose Clement Attlee's Labour Party, which implemented it: the National Insurance Act and the National Health Service Act in 1946, then the National Assistance Act in 1948. On 5 July 1948, the NHS, led by Aneurin Bevan, began to provide care free at the point of use, financed by taxation. The war thus turned a report into a Welfare State.
4. Final result: the chain goes from wartime expectations to a report, an election and laws; the British model is universal and tax-funded.

Traps to avoid : Listing events without explaining how one causes the next. · Claiming that Churchill implemented the Beveridge Report after 1945. · Describing the NHS as financed by contributions.

Exercise 3.1 · What did the consensus consist of?

1. 1. (1) False: the Conservatives preserved the Welfare State and the NHS. (2) True: the nationalisations were largely kept, except steel and road haulage. (3) True: Keynesianism was common ground. (4) False: the unions had a recognised role in negotiations (corporatism). (5) True. (6) False: Rab Butler was the Conservative Chancellor of the Exchequer, Hugh Gaitskell his Labour predecessor. (7) False: the existence and extent of the consensus are debated. (8) True: Thatcherism was built as a break with it.
2. 2. The two parties kept competing in elections and disagreed on some points, but they shared the same fundamentals: once in power, the Conservatives did not undo Labour's work and pursued similar economic policies. The consensus is a tacit agreement on the framework, not the absence of political rivalry. The word 'Butskellism' stresses this continuity between a Labour Chancellor and his Conservative successor.
3. Final result: four pillars to remember for an essay: Welfare State, mixed economy, Keynesian full employment, role of the unions.

Traps to avoid : Thinking that the consensus means there were no differences between parties. · Inverting the parties of Butler and Gaitskell.

Exercise 3.2 · Stop-go and the European question: putting things in order

1. 1. c -> e -> a -> d -> b. Go: the government boosts demand (c). Demand attracts imports and pushes prices up, creating inflation and a balance-of-payments deficit (e). This deficit weakens sterling (a). To defend the pound, the government imposes restraint (d): this is the 'stop'. The economy slows down and unemployment rises, after which a new expansion begins (b).
2. 2. The cycle prevents steady growth: each expansion is interrupted before it can bear fruit. Britain therefore grows, but more slowly than West Germany, France or Japan: this is relative decline, not absolute impoverishment. The devaluations of 1949 and 1967 show the weakness of sterling.
3. 3. 1957: EEC turned down. 1960: EFTA founded. 1963: first veto by de Gaulle (against the 1961 application). 1973: accession on 1 January under Heath, with Ireland and Denmark. 1975: referendum in June, about 67% for staying in.
4. 4. Britain gave priority to the Commonwealth, to its special relationship with the United States and to its sovereignty, so it refused the ECSC and the EEC. When it saw the dynamism of the EEC, it applied in 1961 (Macmillan) and 1967 (Wilson), but General de Gaulle vetoed both applications. It only joined in 1973.
5. Final result: Part A order c-e-a-d-b; Part B 1957 EEC refused, 1960 EFTA, 1963 veto, 1973 accession, 1975 referendum.

Traps to avoid : Confusing the 1975 referendum (Yes to staying in) with the 2016 referendum (Leave). · Saying that Britain was absent from Europe until 1973 because of its own refusal only: the vetoes matter too. · Confusing relative decline with absolute impoverishment.

Exercise 3.3 · How the crisis of the 1970s paved the way for Thatcher

1. 1. Miners' strikes (1972 and 1974) -> oil shock (1973) and three-day week (early 1974) -> Heath's defeat in February 1974 -> IMF loan (1976, Callaghan) with spending cuts -> Winter of Discontent (1978-1979) -> vote of no confidence against Callaghan (March 1979), then Thatcher's victory (May 1979).
2. 2. Stagflation is inflation combined with stagnation and unemployment (inflation above 20% in 1975 while unemployment rose). Keynesian policy fights unemployment by boosting demand, but that would increase inflation further: the usual remedy no longer worked, which discredited the consensus economics.
3. 3. Possible plan. I. The unions against governments: the miners' strikes defeat Heath, who loses after asking 'Who governs Britain?'; the Winter of Discontent (strikes in the public sector, refuse collectors, transport, hospitals) ruins Labour's incomes policy. II. An economic crisis that Keynesianism cannot solve: oil shock, stagflation, the humiliation of the 1976 IMF loan and its spending cuts. III. A political opening for a break: Callaghan falls on a vote of no confidence in March 1979; the Conservatives, campaigning against Labour's record, win in May 1979, and Thatcher will define herself against the consensus.
4. Final result: the 1970s showed that the consensus tools (union consultation, Keynesian demand management) no longer worked, which made Thatcher's alternative credible.

Traps to avoid : Confusing the Winter of Discontent (1978-1979, Callaghan) with the miners' strike of 1984-1985 (Thatcher). · Saying that Heath was a Labour Prime Minister: he was a Conservative. · Writing a narrative without a central idea in each part.

Exercise 4.1 · Keynesianism or monetarism? Privatisation or deregulation?

1. 1. A1: K (full employment through demand). A2: M (inflation first). A3: K (demand management). A4: M (control of the money supply is the core of monetarism). A5: M (part of the Thatcherite policy of reducing the deficit and 'rolling back the frontiers of the state').
2. 2. B1: P (the state sells a public corporation). B2: D (new rules for the Stock Exchange; nobody is sold). B3: U (Trade Union Act 1984). B4: D (removal of restrictions on currency movements). B5: P. B6: U (Employment Acts).
3. 3. Both phrases express the refusal of a 'U-turn', that is, a return to reflationary Keynesian policies, even though the 1980-1981 recession was pushing unemployment towards three million. Thatcher presented monetarism as the only possible policy.
4. Final result: Keynesianism targets employment through demand; monetarism targets inflation through money. Privatisation changes the owner; deregulation changes the rules.

Traps to avoid : Classifying the Big Bang as a privatisation. · Thinking that monetarism aimed at reducing unemployment in the short term: it accepted unemployment as the price of lower inflation.

Exercise 4.2 · A Thatcherite timeline and the aims of privatisation

1. 1. 1979: abolition of exchange controls. 1980: Right to Buy (Housing Act). 1984: British Telecom; March 1984 - March 1985: miners' strike. 1986: British Gas ('Tell Sid'); 27 October 1986: Big Bang. 1987: British Airways and Rolls-Royce. 31 March 1990: Trafalgar Square riot against the poll tax; April 1990: poll tax in England and Wales. November 1990: Thatcher resigns.
2. 2. Aims: efficiency through competition and profit; revenue for the state; reduced trade union influence in the public corporations; and 'popular capitalism', i.e. spreading share ownership among ordinary citizens (advertising campaigns such as 'Tell Sid'). 'Property-owning democracy' follows the same logic for housing: with Right to Buy, council tenants could buy their homes and become owners.
3. 3. For: efficiency gains in some sectors; revenue for the state. Against: share ownership became concentrated again; price rises; private monopolies that required regulators.
4. Final result: privatisation was both an economic and a political project, meant to change the relationship between citizens, the state and property.

Traps to avoid : Dating the poll tax in England to 1989: 1989 is Scotland. · Forgetting that Right to Buy concerns housing, not a company.

Exercise 4.3 · Why did Margaret Thatcher leave office in 1990? An essay plan

1. 1. Thatcher did not lose a general election. She was removed by her own party: after Geoffrey Howe's resignation and speech in November 1990, Michael Heseltine challenged her for the Conservative leadership; with insufficient support in the first round, she withdrew and resigned at the end of November 1990. John Major succeeded her as party leader and therefore as Prime Minister. This is consistent with the institutions: the Prime Minister is the leader of the majority party.
2. 2. The poll tax (officially the Community Charge) replaced local taxes based on the value of homes with a flat-rate charge per adult, regardless of income: a poor household paid as much per adult as a rich one. It led to widespread non-payment and violent demonstrations (London, 31 March 1990).
3. 3. I. An unpopular reform: the poll tax, introduced in Scotland (1989) then in England and Wales (April 1990), non-payment and the Trafalgar Square riot. II. A divided party: disagreements over Europe, Howe's resignation and his resignation speech. III. The trigger, a party revolt: Heseltine's challenge, the first-round result, Thatcher's withdrawal and Major's succession. Conclusion: the poll tax was replaced by the council tax in 1993.
4. Final result: Thatcher fell because an unpopular policy and divisions over Europe turned her own party against her.

Traps to avoid : Saying that Thatcher was defeated by Labour in an election. · Mixing up the poll tax (1989-1990) and the council tax (1993).

Exercise 5.1 · Old Labour or New Labour? Devolution or federalism?

1. 1. Old Labour: common ownership (old Clause IV); the 1946-1951 nationalisations; close links with the unions. New Labour: acceptance of the market economy; welfare to work; no renationalisation; investment in education and health within a market economy. Blair rewrote Clause IV in 1995 precisely to mark this break.
2. 2. Devolution is a transfer of powers from Westminster to elected institutions in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland, but Westminster remains sovereign and could, in law, take back these powers. In federalism, the sharing of sovereignty is guaranteed. The United Kingdom therefore remains a unitary state.
3. 3. Since 1999 health and education in Scotland are decided by the Scottish Parliament, but Scottish MPs still sit at Westminster and can vote on health or education laws that apply only to England, while English MPs cannot vote on the same matters for Scotland. That asymmetry is the West Lothian question.
4. 4. England: its laws are made by Westminster.
5. Final result: New Labour = market + social investment; devolution = powers transferred, sovereignty kept at Westminster.

Traps to avoid : Calling the United Kingdom a federal state. · Thinking that New Labour renationalised the companies privatised by Thatcher.

Exercise 5.2 · The years 1992-1998: a timeline and the Good Friday Agreement

1. 1. 16 September 1992: Black Wednesday, sterling leaves the European Exchange Rate Mechanism (Major). 1993: Maastricht, Downing Street Declaration (Major). 1995: Clause IV rewritten (Tony Blair). 1 May 1997: New Labour landslide (Blair). 1997: Bank of England independence (Blair). 10 April 1998: signature of the Good Friday Agreement (Blair). 22 May 1998: approval by referendum in Northern Ireland and in the Republic of Ireland (Blair). 1999: Scottish Parliament and Welsh Assembly (Blair).
2. 2. Under speculative attack, the pound had to leave the European Exchange Rate Mechanism: the Conservatives' economic credibility collapsed, even though growth later returned. Added to divisions over Maastricht and sleaze, this prepared the 1997 defeat.
3. 3. Principle of consent: Northern Ireland remains British for as long as a majority of its population wishes. Power-sharing: the Assembly and Executive bring together unionists and nationalists. Cooperation: North-South bodies and a British-Irish Council. Also: decommissioning of paramilitary weapons and early release of prisoners.
4. 4. Northern Ireland is part of the United Kingdom, while the Republic of Ireland is an independent state and a member of the EU. When the United Kingdom left the EU, the border between the two became an external EU border, which threatened the open cooperation built by the Agreement.
5. Final result: 1992-1997 shows the Conservatives losing credibility; 1997-1998 shows New Labour's reforms and the peace process.

Traps to avoid : Attributing the Good Friday Agreement to Major: he launched the peace process (1993), Blair's government signed the Agreement. · Confusing the exit from the Exchange Rate Mechanism (1992) with the exit from the EU (2020). · Confusing Northern Ireland and the Republic of Ireland.

Exercise 6.1 · Presenting a document and avoiding paraphrase

1. 1. Nature: a newspaper editorial (an opinion text). Author: James Holt, the editor. Date: 15 November 1984. Source: The Northern Courier, a national daily. Audience: its readers, especially in the industrial North. Context: the miners' strike (March 1984 - March 1985), led by the NUM against pit closures, under Thatcher's government which was curbing union power.
2. 2. S1: paraphrase, it only repeats the text. S2: commentary, it adds the date and leader of the strike and the role of the National Coal Board. S3: paraphrase, again a repetition with 'the author says'. S4: commentary and critical perspective, it points out what the author leaves out (no national ballot), which is exactly what the course asks for.
3. 3. Model: This document is an editorial written by James Holt, editor of The Northern Courier, and published on 15 November 1984. At the time, Britain was facing the miners' strike, which the NUM had launched in March 1984 against pit closures, and the editor clearly takes the side of the mining communities.
4. Final result: a commentary always adds context and a critical view to what the text says.

Traps to avoid : Starting every sentence with 'the author says': a sign of paraphrase. · Forgetting the audience and the point of view of an opinion text such as an editorial.

Exercise 6.2 · Building a commentary plan for a 1997 campaign speech

1. 1. 'Old ways of nationalisation': Clause IV (common ownership), rewritten by Blair in 1995; New Labour refuses to renationalise. 'Minimum wage': the national minimum wage, created in 1998. 'Scotland its own Parliament': devolution, the referendum of September 1997 and the Scotland Act 1998. 'Eighteen years of Conservative government': from Thatcher's victory in May 1979 to 1997 (Thatcher then Major). 'Black Wednesday': 16 September 1992, sterling leaves the European Exchange Rate Mechanism and the Conservatives lose their economic credibility.
2. 2. Possible central question: How does this speech reflect New Labour's attempt to combine a break with Old Labour and an alternative to Conservative rule?
3. 3. I. A modernised Labour Party: no return to nationalisation, acceptance of the market (the Third Way). II. A programme of social justice and constitutional reform: minimum wage, Scottish Parliament; the choice of Glasgow shows the speech targets Scottish voters. III. An attack on a worn-out government: eighteen years in power, Black Wednesday; but the speaker is silent on what New Labour keeps from Thatcherism, a limit to point out.
4. 4. Model conclusion: This speech thus sheds light on the New Labour synthesis of market economics and social reform, which helped win the landslide of 1 May 1997. Its promises were kept: the national minimum wage and the Scotland Act both date from 1998, and the Scottish Parliament was elected in 1999. Yet devolution did not extinguish Scottish nationalism, as the 2014 independence referendum would show.
5. Final result: a document becomes a commentary when each reference is explained, grouped by theme and placed in a longer history.

Traps to avoid : Following the order of the text line by line. · Forgetting the critical part: what the speaker does not say. · Ending without an opening.

Exercise 6.3 · Essay plan: Thatcherism and the post-war consensus

1. 1. Keynesian full employment: break, monetarism gives priority to inflation; unemployment over three million in 1980-1981; TINA. Mixed economy: break, privatisation of BT (1984), British Gas (1986), water (1989), electricity (1990-1991), and the Big Bang (1986). Role of the unions: break, Employment Acts 1980 and 1982, Trade Union Act 1984, defeat of the miners in 1985. Welfare State and NHS: the course does not describe their abolition; the NHS still exists, which suggests a limit to the break.
2. 2. Model introduction: The post-war consensus refers to the common ground shared by Conservatives and Labour from 1951 to the 1970s: Welfare State, mixed economy, Keynesian full employment and consultation with the unions. Thatcherism, the policy of Margaret Thatcher (1979-1990), explicitly defined itself against it. To what extent did it actually break with it? We will see that the break was deep in economic policy and in relations with the unions, but that it had limits and was in part prolonged by its successors.
3. 3. I. A deliberate economic break: from Keynesianism to monetarism; from a mixed economy to privatisation and deregulation. II. A political break with the 1970s model: the end of corporatism, union laws, the miners' strike. III. The limits of the break: the NHS remains; strict monetarism was gradually relaxed; the poll tax failed and led to Thatcher's fall; and New Labour accepted the Thatcherite legacy, which shows a new consensus rather than a simple break.
4. Final result: Thatcherism broke deeply with the economic and industrial consensus but left the core of the Welfare State in place and created a new framework that New Labour kept.

Traps to avoid : Answering 'completely' without nuance. · Inventing statistics or events that are not in the course. · Forgetting to define 'consensus' in the introduction.

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